

YDZ ENGLISH

TERM 2

WEEK 11

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

The **present perfect** is formed from the present tense of the verb *have* and the **past participle** of a verb.

Present Perfect Tense

Subject	Helping Verb	Main Verb (Past Participle)
I You They We	have	decided finished lost
She He It	has	chosen gone

We use the present perfect:

- for something that **started in the past** and **continues in the present**:

They've been married for nearly fifty years.

She has lived in Liverpool all her life.

- when we are talking about our **experience up to the present**:

I've seen that film before.

I've played the guitar ever since I was a teenager.

He has written three books and he is working on another one.

We often use the adverb **ever** to talk about experience up to the present:

My last birthday was the worst day I have ever had.

and we use **never** for the **negative form**:

Have you ever met George?

Yes, but I've never met his wife.

- for something that **happened in the past** but is **important in the present**:

I can't get in the house. I've lost my keys.

Teresa isn't at home. I think she has gone shopping.

have been and *have gone*

We use ***have/has been*** when someone has ***gone*** to a place and ***returned***:

*A: Where **have** you **been**?*

*B: I've just **been** out to the supermarket.*

*A: **Have** you **ever been to** San Francisco?*

*B: No, but I've **been to** Los Angeles.*

But when someone **has not returned**, we use ***have/has gone***:

A: Where's Maria? I haven't seen her for weeks.

*B: She's **gone to** Paris for a week. She'll be back tomorrow.*

Present perfect with time adverbials

We often use the present perfect with adverbials **which refer to the recent past**:

<i>recently</i>	<i>just</i>	<i>only just</i>
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*Scientists **have recently discovered** a new breed of monkey.*

*We **have just got** back from our holidays.*

or **adverbials which include the present**:

<i>so far</i>	<i>until now</i>	<i>up to now</i>
<i>ever (in questions)</i>		
<i>yet (in questions and negatives)</i>		

***Have** you **ever** seen a ghost?*

*Where **have** you **been up to now**?*

*A: **Have** you **finished** your homework **yet**?*

*B: No, **so far** I've only **done** my history.*

After a clause with the present perfect we often use **a clause with *since* to show when something started in the past**:

*I've worked here **since I left school**.*

*I've been watching that program every week **since it started**.*

FOR AND SINCE

For and since are used with the present perfect to indicate time.

For

We use for to talk about a period of time (*a few days, half an hour, two years...*)

Examples:

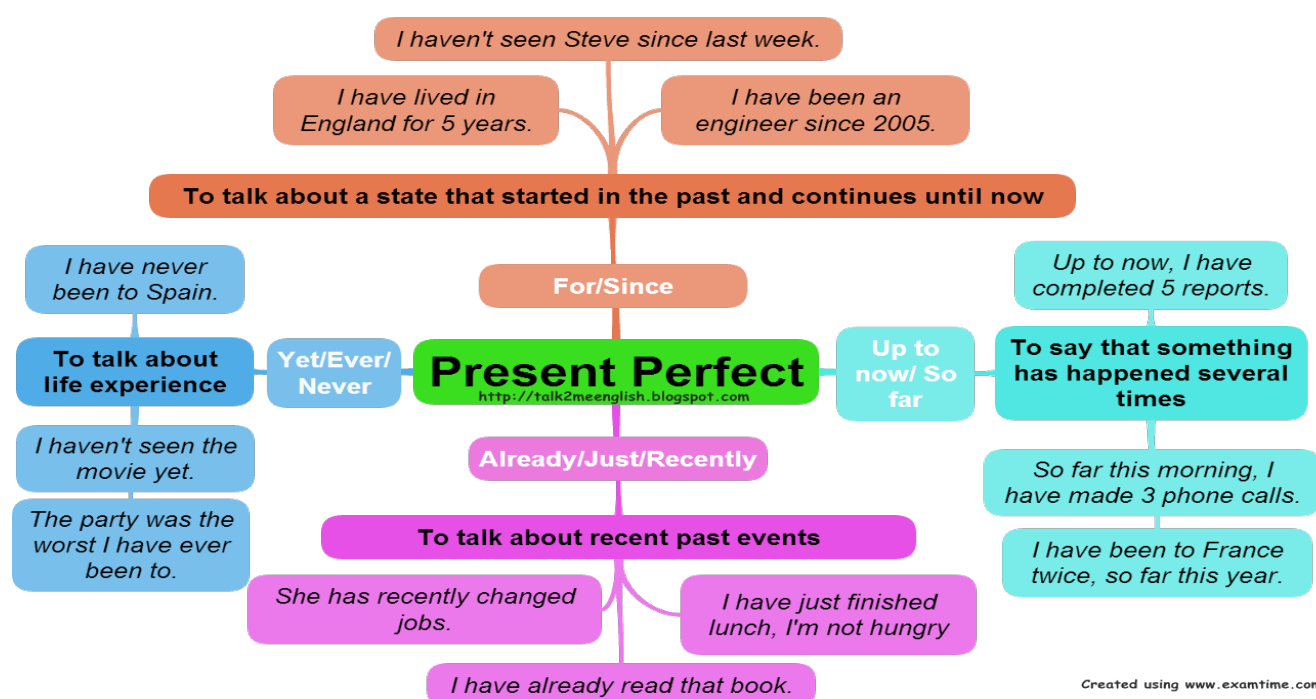
- He has studied in Dublin for 3 years.
- We have worked for 2 hours.

Since

We use since to talk about a specific point in time, or a time when the action started (*last year, June 8, 9 o'clock...*)

Examples:

- We have learnt Spanish here since 2002.
- I have loved you since the first time I met you.



EXERCISES

A. Complete the sentences with the present perfect of the verbs in brackets.

1. I (not / work) _____ today.
2. We (buy) _____ a new lamp.
3. We (not / plan) _____ our holiday yet.
4. Where (be / you) _____?
5. He (write) _____ five letters.
6. She (not / see) _____ him for a long time.
7. (be / you) _____ at school?
8. School (not / start) _____ yet.
9. (speak / he) _____ to his boss?
10. Sophie and I (know) _____ each other since we were at school together.
11. I (play) _____ tennis since I was eight years old.
12. Alain (be) _____ in hospital three times this year.
13. I (want) _____ to be an actor for as long as I can remember.
14. My uncle (smoke) _____ 40 cigarettes a day for 40 years – and he's a doctor!
15. You (have) _____ that suit for more than ten years! Isn't it time to get a new one?